

INTERNATIONAL EXCHANGE AND COOPERATION

The Department of Administrative Reforms & Public Grievances (DARPG) engages in bilateral and multilateral exchange and cooperation through its international exchange and cooperation division. Such exchange and cooperation is undertaken in the field of Public Administration and Governance, which includes, among other things, organizing programmes and visits of Indian delegations to foreign countries and visits of foreign delegations to India as part of projects / bilateral measures in furtherance of activities included in the Memorandum of Understandings (MOUs) / Agreements signed between India and other countries (bilateral or multilateral).

The aim of international exchange and cooperation component is to share information, best practices and personnel across national governments. Presently bilateral MoUs in the areas of Public Administration and Governance have been signed with Portugal, United Kingdom, Singapore, Australia, The Gambia, France, Cambodia and Malaysia.

India – Singapore Cooperation

The MoU between DARPG and the Public Service Division (PSD) of the Republic of Singapore is for cooperation in the field of 'Personnel Management and Public Administration'. The areas of cooperation under the MoU include (i) Workforce, Workplace and Jobs; (ii) Public Service Delivery; (iii) Human Resource Management; (iv) Public Sector Reform; (v) Leadership/Talent Development; and (vi) E-Governance / Digital Government.

- The first bilateral meeting was held on 6th July, 2021.
- The second bilateral meeting was held on 29th September, 2022.
- Third bilateral meeting was held on 10.09.2024.

The MoU has been extended for a period of five years from 1st June 2023 to 31st May 2028.

A bilateral introductory meeting between Shri V. Srinivas, Secretary, DARPG and Ms. Tan Gee Keow, Permanent Secretary, PSD, Singapore was held on 30th January, 2024 through video conferencing.

India - Australia Cooperation

The MoU between DARPG and the Australian Public Service Commission (APSC) is for cooperation in the field of Public Administration and Governance Reforms. The areas of cooperation under the MoU include

- i. Promoting transparency and accountability in delivery of public services;
 - ii. Building effective service delivery in the public service;
 - iii. Recruitment and promotion in the public service;
 - iv. Developing a framework for values and competencies;
 - v. Training and capacity building of the public service;
 - vi. Public Sector Management and Reform;
 - vii. Public Grievance Redress Mechanism;
 - viii. Facilitating short-term foreign training programmes for officers of Government of India or Australia; and
 - ix. Promoting and utilizing potential of retired government servants.
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- The first Joint Working Group was held in Canberra in which a three member delegation led by Joint Secretary DARPG visited Canberra from 13-14th October, 2022.
 - The second Joint Working Group was held on 18.11.2024 in which the areas for collaboration identified were digital service delivery, capacity building initiatives including i-GOT platform, Australia's integration of AI and Australia's Survey of Trust in Public Services.
 - Webinar on 'Workforce Initiatives' was organized jointly by DARPG with the Australian Public Service Commission on 24th February, 2022. The webinar was co-chaired by Joint Secretary, DARPG from the Indian side and Ms. Phoebe Greentree, Executive Director, APSC from the Australian side. 20 participants from both sides participated in the webinar.

- Webinar on “Ethics in Governances” was organised on 06.04.2023 and was co-chaired by Additional Secretary, DARPG and Mr. Mark Colwell, Director, Australian Public Service Commission.
- Webinar on “Best Innovation Practices in Governance” was held on 8th August, 2023.

India - Gambia Cooperation

The MoU between DARPG and the Department and the Public Service Commission, Office of the President, The Gambia is for cooperation on ‘Refurbishing Personnel Administration and Governance Reforms’. The MoU stands extended for further 5 years beyond 2024.

- The First Joint Working Group (JWG) was held in virtual mode on 22nd November, 2021.
- The Second Joint Working Group meeting was held by video conference on 21.08.2023.
- The Third Joint Working Group was held on 09.11.2023 through VC.

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India - France Cooperation

The Letter of Intent between DARPG and Ministry of Public Sector Transformation & the Civil Service of the French Republic was signed on 02nd November, 2023 for Cooperation in the field of Public Administration and Administrative Reforms for three years. The areas of cooperation under the MoU include:-

- i. promote co-operation in the field of Civil Service
- ii. Human Resource Management;
- iii. Public Administration and Administrative Reforms.



India-Portugal Cooperation

The MoU between DARPG and the Ministry of the Presidency and of Administrative Modernization of the Portuguese Republic was signed on 24th June, 2017 for Co-operation in the field of Public Administration and Governance Reforms.

- The first Meeting of Senior Consultative Body was held in Lisbon, Portugal on 8-9 May, 2018.
- The second meeting of the Senior Consultative Body between the DARPG and the Administrative Modernization Agency of Portugal was held on 12th Dec, 2023 through VC.

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India - Cambodia Co-operation

The MoU between DARPG and The Ministry of Civil Service of the Kingdom of Cambodia is for Co-operation in the field of Human Resource Development in the Civil Services. The Areas of Co-operation of the said MoU are as under:-

- i. Policy planning and implementation of innovation in human resource development including training and Capacity Building Programs;
- ii. Senior Level Civil Servants of Cambodia, preferably, having at least 10 years work experience in the field of Public Administration to be trained under the Capacity Building Programmes of National Centre for Good Governance, an autonomous organisation of the Department of Administrative Reforms & Public Grievances, during the duration of the MoU;
- iii. Information systems for public personnel administration;
- iv. Engage and support policy research and development on human resource in the field of civil service;
- v. Ethics, conduct, and discipline in the civil service;
- vi. Such other areas of cooperation as may be jointly decided upon by the Participants.

Training programs are conducted for Cambodian civil servants in India.

India – Malaysia Cooperation

The MoU between DARPG and Public Service Department, Prime Minister's Department, Government of Malaysia has been signed for Cooperation in the field of Public Administration and Governance Reforms' for a period of five (05) years. The MoU was signed on 20 August, 2024 during the visit of Prime Minister of Malaysia to India.

A Joint Working Group Meeting between DARPG and Public Service Department, Malaysia was held on 13.11.2024 in which the following collaborations were identified:

- i. A Joint Working Group to be constituted for formulating training of the Malaysian Civil Servants in National Centre for Good Governance (NCGG). The Joint Working Group will include DG NCGG, DDG PSD Malaysia, Sr. officials from DARPG and MEA;
- ii. A joint webinar would be organised for sharing of best practices by both the Governments which may include areas like right sizing of Government, Public Services Act' performance based rewards etc.

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Cooperation with Commonwealth

- DARPG was invited for the 3rd Biennial Pan-Commonwealth Heads of Public Service on "Institutionalisation of Smart Government to enhance public service delivery" held in April 2024 at London to make a presentation in the session on "Centralized Public Grievance Redressal System: A Foundation for SMART Government".
- This forum had brought together Commonwealth Heads of Public Service, Secretaries to Cabinet, Senior Public Officials, industry champions and eminent scholars to share contemporary knowledge, ideas and experiences on leveraging technology to support sustainable development across common wealth, to share select case studies and to identify opportunities for possible partnership and collaboration.
- Some of the key outcomes of this meeting were acknowledging the importance of digital governance in improvement of public service delivery, importance of transformative technologies such as Artificial Intelligence and Sustainable Development.
- The Centralized Public Grievance Redress and Monitoring System (CPGRAMS) of India was one of the four future ready governance best practices identified for sharing with the Commonwealth.

- In the Bilateral Meeting with the Secretary General Commonwealth, India discussed its support for the Commonwealth AI Consortium and replication of technology advancement in governance in Commonwealth Member Countries and the Convening of the 4th Annual Meeting of the Commonwealth Heads of Public Service/Secretaries to Cabinet in New Delhi in 2026.
- The Commonwealth Secretariat evinced interest for collaboration with India on key aspects of smart governance i.e. (i) advancing the digital transformation of member countries particularly improving delivery of public services and; (ii) India's support in accelerating the efforts of the Commonwealth AI Consortium.
- During the visit of Ms. Shirley Botchway, H.E. Secretary General-Elect to India on 21st March 2025 DARPG presented the Centralized Public Grievance Redress and Monitoring System (CPGRAMS), the initiatives for improving public service delivery and the digitisation of secretariat through e-Office.

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Cooperation with International Institute of Administrative Sciences (IIAS)

- Established in 1930, IIAS is a non-profit international association headquartered in Brussels, Belgium. It is a federation of member states, national sections and academic research centres, in which, at present, 98 countries are associated.
- IIAS *inter alia* promotes worldwide development of administrative sciences, better organization and operation of public administrative agencies and improvement of administrative methods and techniques. It connects governments, administrative bodies, international organizations, educational institutions, and experts to achieve its goals.
- DARPG is an institutional member of the IIAS since 1998. Secretary DARPG is a member in the CoA of IIAS from India. India intends to benefit from IIAS's global knowledge resource in administrative sciences by on-boarding more and more Indian institutes and universities to the IIAS platform. India is contesting for Presidency in the Council of Administration (CoA) for the IIAS as IIAS will enable India to present its viewpoint on governance in many countries of Europe and Africa.
- India hosted the Annual IIAS-DARPG India Conference 2025, held in New Delhi from 10-14 February 2025. This 2025 Annual Conference of IIAS held in New Delhi was a remarkable success. The five-day event comprising 66 breakout sessions and 7 plenary sessions witnessed the participation of over 750 delegates from 58 countries, including

policymakers, academics, and practitioners, who engaged in discussions on transformative governance models and inclusive public administration. A 710-page volume edited by distinguished authors and experts titled "Viksit Bharat@2047: Governance Transformed" was launched. The book delves into India's governance evolution and outlines a strategic road map to achieve developed nation status by 2047.

Capacity Building in the field of Public Administration and Governance

In order to understand the framework for public service reforms and its implications on service delivery and also to gain insight about e-governance initiatives and approaches in other countries, the Department organizes exposure visits for short term duration (one week) in specific areas of interests in Institutes of international repute for PM Awardees and e-Governance Awardees and also AR Secretaries of States/UTs, Nodal officers of Ministries/Departments of Government of India based on their performances in handling the Public Grievances on CPGRAMS, etc

Due to travel restrictions imposed worldwide after the outbreak of Covid-19, no such training programme could be organized by the Department after 2019.

DETAILS OF TRAINING PROGRAMME ORGANIZED DURING 2013-14 TO 2018-19 (TO BE HYPERLINKED).

(MAY 2025)